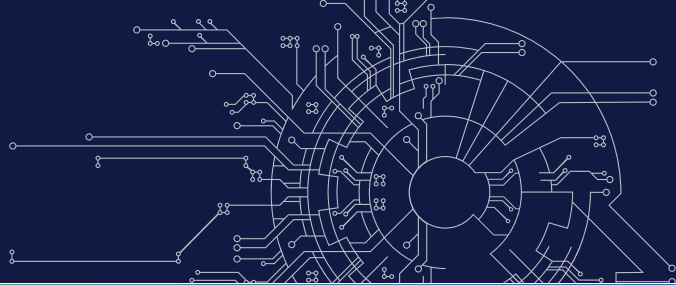


Nigeria Artificial Intelligence Industry Collective



NIGERIA AI COLLECTIVE COMMUNITY MONTHLY DIGEST

MONTH ENDING OCTOBER 2025

This Month's Highlights...

DAWN AI Study pioneers neuro-inclusive AI for neurodivergent learners in Africa

DAWN AI Study stands at the forefront as Africa's first neuro-inclusion platform, leveraging artificial intelligence to radically transform learning for neurodivergent students across the continent. This innovative initiative addresses the challenge faced by millions of African children with conditions such as ADHD, dyslexia, and autism, who often remain undiagnosed or underserved due to limited clinical resources and accessibility constraints in many regions.

The flagship technology, AIDA (AI Diagnostic Agent), makes early detection and personalised learning support affordable and scalable by running on mobile devices accessible in schools, homes, and clinics. It utilises psychometric, behavioural, and multimodal data such as voice, text, and visuals to deliver rapid and context-sensitive diagnostics, facilitating tailored educational interventions. DAWN AI's dashboards provide actionable insights for parents, teachers, specialists, and policymakers alike, creating a collaborative ecosystem for inclusive education.

Beyond immediate educational impact, DAWN AI Study is pioneering policy intelligence tools that help governments and NGOs design more effective inclusive education strategies. Its vision is to become the primary triage layer for neurodivergence in Africa, enabling 90% of learners to receive early, accessible care through AI-powered screening, while complex cases are escalated to specialist partners. With partnerships spreading across multiple African countries and recognition from global accelerators, DAWN AI Study is reshaping how neurodiversity is approached in African education systems.

Dyslexia

Built for Real Lives. Backed by Neuroscience. Designed for Every Mind. Powered by Compassion. Ready for the World

ADHD

AIDA BY DAWN AI STUDY: The AI Diagnostic & Learning Companion for Every Neurodivergent Journey

AIDA (AI Diagnostic Agent) is your all in one, role based platform designed to identify, understand, and support learners from home to school, clinic to community.

Whether you're a parent, teacher, clinician, or the learner, AIDA meets you where you are with personalized support built for real lives not just test scores.

[Start Free Assessment](#)

[Watch demo](#)

Dyspraxia

Speech Delays

Supporting Every Learning Journey

At DataFest Africa 2025, Africa's premier event for data and artificial intelligence, the Nigeria AI Collective took a leading role in showcasing bold new initiatives designed to accelerate Nigeria's AI ecosystem. The event, held in Lagos under the theme "AI in Africa: Solving Today's Problems, Building Tomorrow's Systems", drew over 3,000 participants in person and lots more online, uniting the continent's AI innovators, practitioners and researchers.

As an official partner and exhibitor, the Collective highlighted its commitment to ethical AI development aligned with Nigeria's National AI Strategy. Key announcements included the launch of the National AI Repository, a centralised platform that aggregates datasets, AI solutions, and events to foster collaboration and open knowledge sharing within Nigeria's AI community.

The Nigeria AI Collective also introduced a National AI Hackathon that leverages 3,000 hours of curated Nigerian language datasets to drive the creation of locally relevant AI solutions rooted in cultural and linguistic contexts.

Recognising the importance of supporting emerging innovators, the Collective opened applications to join its Community of Practice and Contribution to the National AI Repository, aimed at promoting mentorship, networking, and growth opportunities for AI startups/Tech Innovators across Nigeria.

These initiatives underscore the Collective's mission to build a sustainable, inclusive and ethical AI ecosystem that empowers innovators, bridges research and real-world application, and positions Nigeria as a continental leader in responsible AI development.

The Nigeria AI Collective operates with the support of Luminate, Ford Foundation, and AI Collaborative, and is managed by Data Science Nigeria, Lagos Business School, and CJID, under the coordination of the Policy Innovation Centre. It continues to foster collaboration across civil society, academia, and industry to ensure AI benefit is broad, ethical, and actionable.



We are
Building Nigeria's
AI Ecosystem

The Nigeria AI Collective is an national, community-driven movement aimed at promoting responsible, inclusive, and impactful AI adoption across Nigeria. We connect researchers, policymakers, startups, diaspora experts, and civil society to co-create a thriving AI ecosystem focused on national development and global competitiveness.

Our mission is to democratize AI access, build capacity, and shape national AI priorities through collaboration and open innovation.

5 Pillars of the Nigeria AI Collective

- Knowledge Sharing and Collaboration**
Facilitate a platform for AI professionals, researchers, policymakers, and industry leaders to share insights, best practices, and research findings. Foster collaboration between academia, industry, and government agencies to strengthen the AI ecosystem.
- Capacity Building**
Develop and implement training programs, workshops, and seminars to enhance the skills of AI practitioners and enthusiasts. Encourage continuous learning and skill development to keep pace with advancements in AI technologies.
- Innovation and Research**
Support and promote AI-focused research and development initiatives that address local challenges and contribute to global AI knowledge. Encourage the creation of AI startups and incubators to drive innovation in various sectors.
- Policy Advocacy**
Collaborate with policymakers to develop AI-friendly regulations and policies that foster a conducive environment for AI research, development, and application. Advocate for ethical AI practices and responsible use of AI technologies in alignment with global standards.
- International Collaboration**
Establish partnerships and collaborations with international AI organisations, institutions, and industry players to leverage global expertise and resources. Position Nigeria as a critical player in the international AI community.

Scan to Visit the National AI Repository







Case Radar's AI Breaks Barriers: Now Accessing Legal Documents Beyond Nigeria

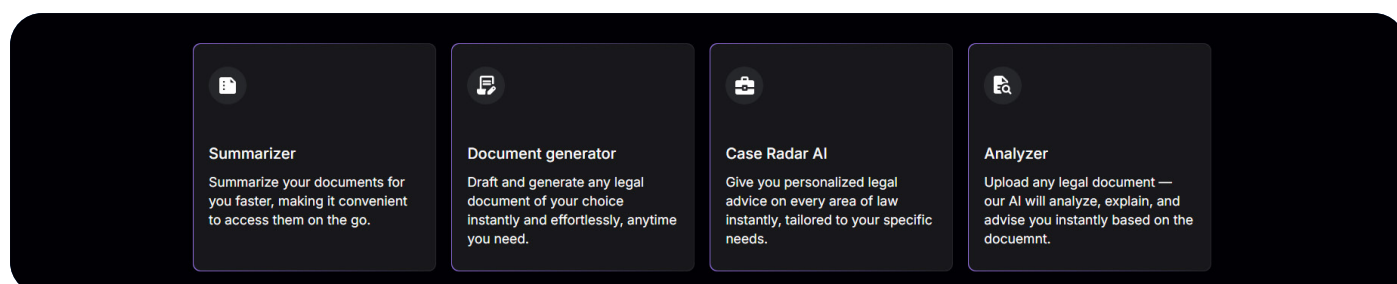
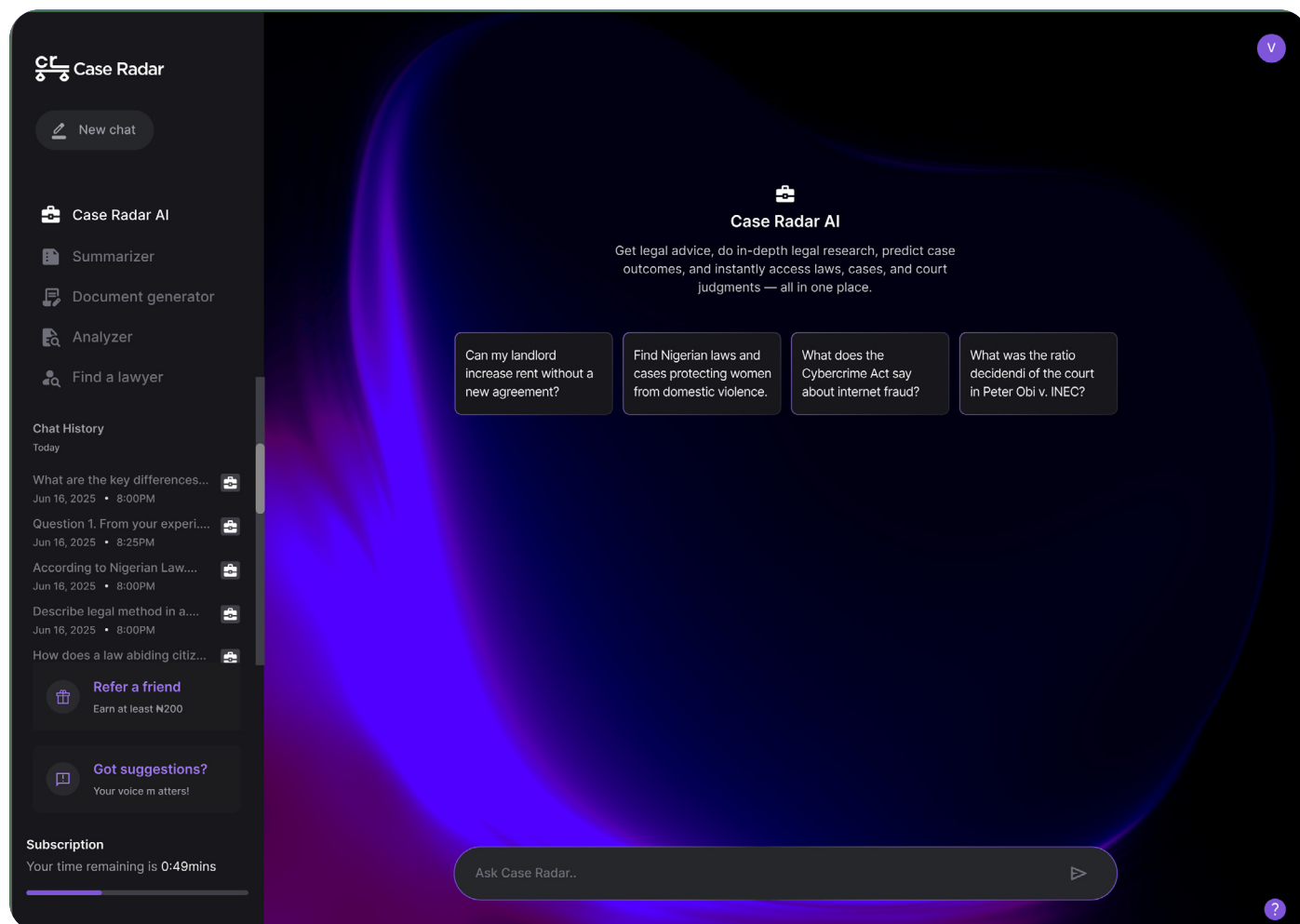
Case Radar, the Nigerian legal tech platform, has significantly expanded its AI capabilities to access and process legal documents beyond Nigeria's borders. This enhancement allows the AI model to autonomously update itself by tapping into external internet sources, retrieving a broader range of legal information from various jurisdictions outside Nigeria. This upgrade is a major step forward for Case Radar, which is Africa's first legal generative AI platform specifically trained on Nigerian laws, now evolving to offer more comprehensive legal insights on a global scale.

The CEO and Co-founder, Agbo Obinnaya, explained that the expansion was driven by user demand and the need to scale the tool's capabilities. Since its launch, Case Radar has become an essential resource for legal interpretation in Nigeria, democratizing access to legal knowledge by bridging gaps between legal professionals and the

public. With this new international legal document access feature, users will benefit from a richer, more up-to-date understanding of legal issues, both locally and globally.

The platform relies on advanced natural language processing and machine learning to analyse legal texts, court judgments, and related documents, and now with this global reach, it stands to further empower lawyers, students, businesses, and individuals seeking legal guidance, making legal services more accessible, affordable, and efficient for a wider audience.

This development not only solidifies Case Radar's position as a leading legal tech innovator in Africa but also positions it as a pioneering platform in global AI-powered legal research and assistance.



Africa's First OpenAI Academy Launches at UNILAG

The University of Lagos (UNILAG) has made history by hosting Africa's first OpenAI Academy, marking a significant milestone in AI education and innovation on the continent. This landmark collaboration between UNILAG and OpenAI was officially announced and launched in October 2025 during UNILAG's 5th International Week, themed "Equitable Partnerships and the Future of AI in Africa." OpenAI Academy at UNILAG serves as a cutting-edge AI training and research hub that provides free courses and capacity-building opportunities to students, researchers, professionals, and innovators across Africa, aiming to democratize access to AI education and empower African talent to actively shape AI's future.

The OpenAI Academy at UNILAG aims to democratise AI knowledge by providing accessible, hands-on training. Participants learn to harness OpenAI's groundbreaking tools like ChatGPT and explore AI applications tailored to local needs in healthcare, agriculture, governance, and more. By bridging academic excellence with real-world innovation, the academy empowers a broad audience from beginners to experienced professionals to become active contributors in Africa's growing AI ecosystem.

UNILAG's selection as the first African hub for OpenAI's academy stems from its stellar reputation in pioneering technological education and research, its vibrant Lagos locale as Nigeria's tech nerve centre, and its commitment to fostering equitable, continent-wide partnerships. OpenAI Africa Lead Emmanuel Lubanzadio emphasises that this synergy will propel African talent to lead and shape AI's future on the global stage.

The academy's curriculum covers foundational AI knowledge, ethical considerations, practical use of AI for societal challenges, and strategic insights into AI-driven innovation. It is open to students, researchers, entrepreneurs, government officials, and enthusiasts eager to leverage AI for impactful solutions.

Vice-Chancellor of UNILAG, Professor Folasade Ogunsola, highlights the academy as a leap forward for Africa to harness AI for homegrown breakthroughs from improving healthcare delivery in rural clinics to advancing governance and education through locally relevant AI innovations.

The UNILAG-OpenAI Academy not only marks an unparalleled advance in capacity building but also signals Africa's arrival as a proactive player in the AI revolution equipped, empowered, and ready to innovate for the continent's unique realities



Emmanuel Lubanzadio, Africa lead at OpenAI and Professor Folasade T. Ogunsola, Unilag vice chancellor

EU and Nigeria Forge New Path in AI Research Partnership

The European Union (EU) and Nigeria have embarked on a strengthened partnership to support collaborative AI research and innovation, signalling a significant milestone in bridging scientific discovery with practical technological solutions that address local and regional challenges.

This strategic collaboration, formalised through the forthcoming Science, Technology and Innovation Agreement, opens doors for Nigerian universities, research institutions, and innovators to co-develop AI applications focused on societal development, productivity enhancement, and inclusive economic opportunities. The partnership envisions Nigerian researchers as central leaders in Africa's AI ecosystem, promoting the creation of stronger innovation clusters and knowledge networks across the continent.

EU officials have highlighted initiatives such as the Generative AI for Africa proposals, designed to stimulate joint projects across Europe and Africa before the October 31 proposal deadline. The emphasis is on projects that responsibly use AI to tackle societal issues while fostering sustainable development goals. This EU-Nigeria alliance represents a forward-thinking blueprint for international cooperation in AI that positions Africa as an active contributor in the global AI research landscape.



Africa's Mobile Operators and GSMA Launch Inclusive AI Initiative

In a significant step towards accelerating AI innovation that truly represents African diversity, GSMA (Groupe Spéciale Mobile Association) in partnership with leading mobile network operators across Africa has launched a continent-wide initiative to develop inclusive AI language models. Bringing together key players such as Airtel, MTN, Orange, Vodacom, and technology partners like Masakhane African Languages Hub and Lelapa AI, the initiative is focused on bridging the glaring language gap in global AI systems.

With over 2,000 languages spoken across Africa, the lack of representation in popular large language models (LLMs) has left billions underserved by digital technologies. The initiative titled "AI Language Models in Africa, By Africa, For Africa" aims to foster innovation in African AI ecosystems by addressing critical challenges around data accessibility, computing resources, talent development, and regulatory policies.

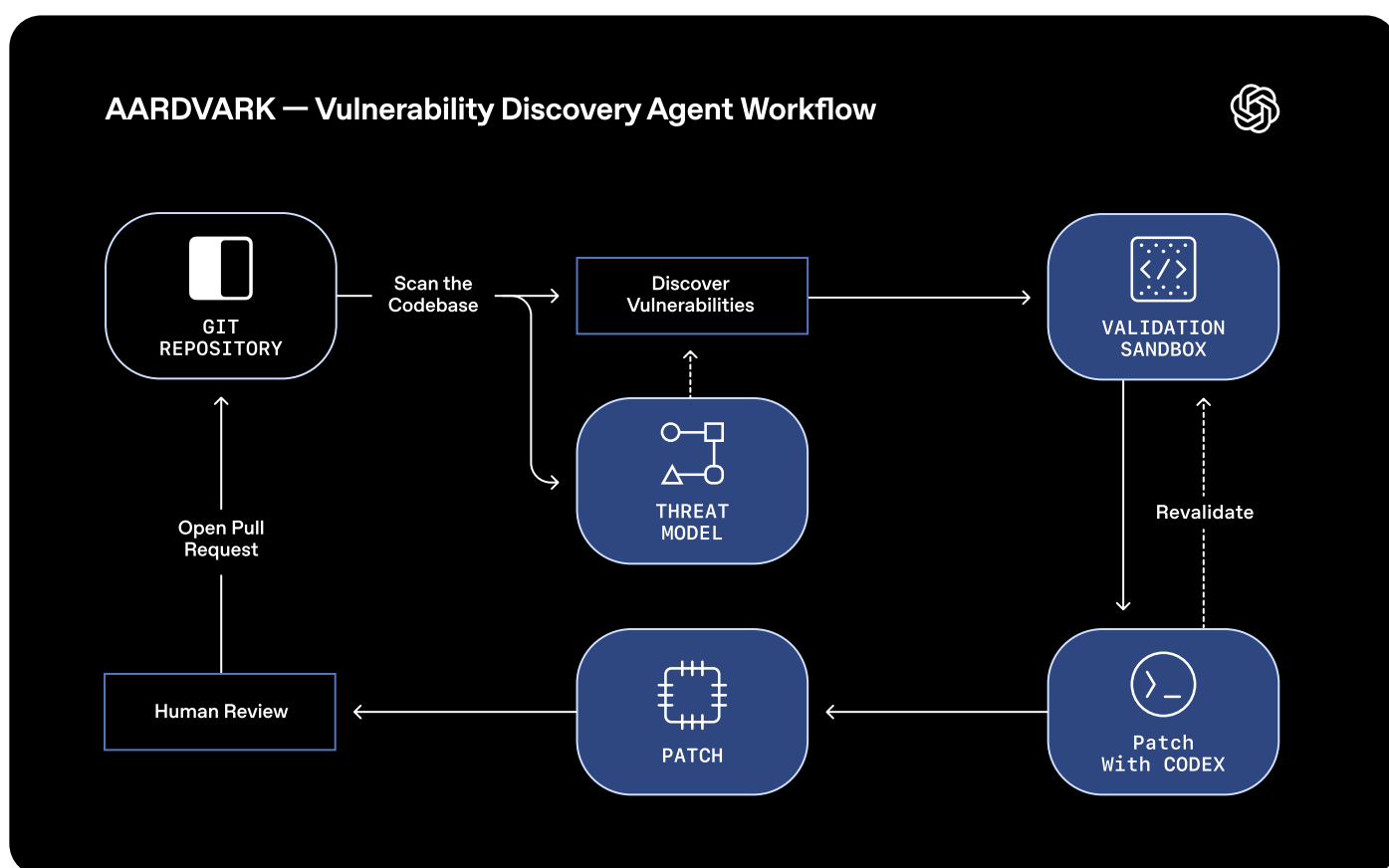
This partnership underlines the crucial role of mobile operators as enablers of digital inclusion, leveraging their vast networks to bring African language AI solutions closer to users on mobile devices. By ensuring AI tools reflect local languages, cultures, and knowledge, the initiative champions a more equitable digital future that empowers African citizens and developers alike.

Meet Aardvark: OpenAI's First-Party Defender in AI Security

OpenAI's latest breakthrough in AI security research is Aardvark, a sophisticated AI agent designed to autonomously detect, analyse, and fix software vulnerabilities. Powered by the advanced GPT-5 architecture, Aardvark functions as a virtual security expert, scanning codebases both proprietary and open-source, to identify potential bugs and offer precise patches before exploits can be weaponised by cyber attackers.

Unlike traditional security tools that rely mainly on signature detection or rule of thumb approaches, Aardvark employs deep reasoning capabilities to understand complex software behaviours. It autonomously validates the presence of bugs, assesses their impact, and integrates seamlessly with platforms such as GitHub for swift remediation workflows. This proactive defender-first model aims to transform software security from reactive patching to anticipatory safeguarding.

Currently in private beta, Aardvark has demonstrated outstanding results in strengthening OpenAI's internal systems and partner projects. Its deployment marks a new chapter in AI-assisted cybersecurity, promising faster vulnerability resolution and a robust defence against the escalating challenges posed by cyber threats in an increasingly AI-driven digital world.



Home-grown Research with Global Recognition

Paper: [Enhancing Maternal and Child Health in Rural Areas Through AI and Mobile Health Solutions](#)

Authors: Ashiata Yetunde Mustapha, Stephen Vure Gbaraba, Busayo Olamide Tomoh, Akachukwu Obianuju Mbata, and Adelaide Yeboah Forkuo, et al.

This paper explores the significant challenges faced in improving maternal and child health in rural Nigerian areas, including geographic isolation, scarce healthcare infrastructure, and shortage of medical professionals. It presents artificial intelligence (AI) and mobile health (mHealth) solutions as transformative tools that can bridge these gaps. AI technologies are highlighted for their predictive analytics, decision support capabilities, and personalised care, which include identifying high-risk pregnancies through analysis of electronic health records and real-time patient data

from wearable devices. mHealth solutions such as smartphones and wearable tech enable remote monitoring of vital health metrics and deliver health education and virtual consultations, thereby improving accessibility to healthcare. The paper discusses the integration of AI and mHealth as a promising pathway to significantly enhance healthcare outcomes for mothers and children in underserved rural settings. It also addresses challenges like technology adoption barriers, data privacy concerns, and the need for infrastructure development. The authors recommend continued investment, research, and collaborative efforts among healthcare providers, technology experts, and communities to ensure sustainable impact and equitable healthcare access. This work underscores the potential of AI and mHealth technologies to transform rural maternal and child healthcare delivery in Nigeria and similar contexts, making a strong case for strategic policy support and technology integration.

Paper: [SabiYarn: Advancing Low Resource Languages with Multitask NLP Pretraining](#)

Authors: Jeffrey Otoibhi, Oduguwa Damilola, and Okpare David

This paper introduces SabiYarn, a novel 125 million parameter decoder-only large language model designed specifically to address the underrepresentation of Nigerian indigenous and low-resource languages in natural language processing. The model covers eight Nigerian languages, including major ones like Yoruba, Igbo, Hausa, Nigerian Pidgin, as well as lesser-represented languages, aiming to preserve cultural and linguistic nuances. The researchers employed a multitask learning framework leveraging techniques such as sequence packing for computational efficiency, enabling the model to perform well on NLP tasks including translation, Named Entity Recognition (NER), text diacritization, sentiment analysis, and topic classification even in zero-shot contexts. Remarkably, SabiYarn outperforms models over 100 times its size on multiple tasks, demonstrating the effectiveness of well-curated datasets and efficient training methods in low-resource settings. Accepted for presentation at the AfricaNLP 2025 Workshop at ACL, this research marks a significant step forward in African AI, promoting democratized, culturally sensitive NLP technology. It challenges the assumption that massive models are necessary for high performance, offering a scalable blueprint for language-specific AI development across diverse linguistic landscapes in Nigeria and beyond. This achievement not only elevates Nigeria's role in global AI research but also contributes directly to greater digital inclusion of minority language speakers.

Opportunities and Events

An overview of upcoming events, available funding, proposal invitations, and other timely opportunities shared within the Community.

Call for Proposals: Predoctoral Grant Program

Boost your doctoral research with a \$25,000 fellowship awarded for one year. This grant supports promising predoctoral fellows conducting rigorous research with strong potential for meaningful impact and future development. Priority goes to projects that clearly demonstrate a pathway from research to real-world application.

Eligible applicants must be currently enrolled doctoral students (MD, PhD, etc.) under mentorship during the application and project period. Research should be performed within the Principal Investigator's lab or through collaborations supported by letters of endorsement.

Deadline – 15th November 2025

Request for Proposals: Pilot Grant Program

A \$75,000 one-year award supporting innovative projects to advance Charcot-Marie-Tooth (CMT) disease research. Open to early-career researchers (PhD, MD, etc.) who earned their degree within the last 10 years and can conduct independent work by September 2025. Projects must be original and independent of existing funded work.

Deadline – 15th November 2025

Submissions open for Public Humanities Fellowship Program

Join a vibrant community of thinkers and scholars committed to reimagining how humanities research engages with society. The fellowship offers the opportunity to develop projects that boost public discourse, increase the visibility of the humanities, and reach diverse audiences across the UK and globally.

Open to recognized professionals in arts, culture, history, languages, philosophy, politics, and related fields, with a proven track record of public engagement. The fellowship includes a three-year associate appointment, library access, and small grants to fund innovative initiatives.

Deadline – 21st November 2025

The Women for Africa Foundation Program

The Women for Africa Foundation is pleased to announce its 11th edition of the Science by Women program to promote African women leadership in scientific research and technology. The Science by Women program offers a 6-month post-doctoral fellowship in collaboration with recognized Spanish Centers of Excellence, addressing key challenges faced by Africa in areas such as health, agriculture, food security, water, mathematics, astronomy, energy, and climate change.

Deadline – 30th November 2025

Upcoming Events

1. AfriTech 5.0: AI & Sovereign Tech

Date: 13th November 2025.

Location: Lagos, Nigeria

Get Ready for AfriTech 5.0!

Africa's biggest tech and policy gathering is back, November 13, 2025, Oriental Hotel, Lagos.

This year's theme: "AI & Sovereign Tech: Building Africa's Digital Independence" – exploring how AI, data sovereignty, and indigenous innovation are shaping Africa's future.



AfriTech 5.0 | AFRICA TECH ALLIANCE FORUM

Our Sponsors

NCC NIGERIAN COMMUNICATIONS COMMISSION

SKOT communications

IXPN www.ixpn.net.ng

itel

DIGITAL REALTY

Theme: AI and Sovereign Tech: Building Africa's Digital Independence

Date: Thursday, November 13, 2025

Venue: Oriental Hotel, Lekki Rd, Lagos

Time: 0900hrs [WAT]

afritechallianceforum.africa





2. XPLORE 2025 - The Rise of Tech Disruptors

Date: 14th November 2025

Location: Abuja, Nigeria

Xplore Disruptors is more than a tech event, it's a bold movement to shape the future of Africa through technology, innovation, and radical collaboration.

3. DevFest Lagos

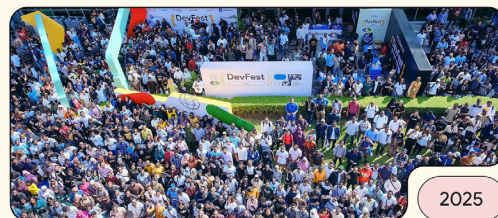
Date: 18th - 22nd November 2025

Location: Lagos, Nigeria

DevFest Lagos 2025 is here to bring together developers, tech enthusiasts, and innovators for an action-packed festival of learning and community. From sessions and workshops to trainings and code labs, you'll connect with world-class speakers and industry leaders driving the future of technology.



DevFest Lagos Returns



2025

**5
Days**

**1
City**

**Nov
18th - 22nd**



Upcoming Events

4. Africa Startup Festival Lagos 2025

Date: 22nd November 2025

Location: Lagos, Nigeria

Distinguished as one of Africa's premier dealmaking and networking events, the Africa Startup Festival is a celebration of innovation, growth, and community within the African Tech Ecosystem.



Thought Leadership



Dr. Evans Woherem

(Chairman, Digital Africa Global Consult (DACE))

Dr. Evans Woherem spoke ahead of Digital Africa Conference & Exhibition event (Oct 28–29, 2025)

“We are entering an era powered by artificial intelligence, just as electricity became the invisible force behind modern civilization, intelligence will soon be embedded in almost everything. AI will not only exist as a standalone technology but will also be integrated into our daily lives, from cars to communications, healthcare, governance, and even social interaction.”

Read more: [Nigeria Communications Week](#)



Dr. Bayo (Olubayo) Adekanmbi

(Founder, Data Science Nigeria)

Dr. Bayo Adekanmbi spoke at the 2025 DSN AI Bootcamp (Oct 23, 2025)

“Don’t stop until you are proud”

Read more: [Post from a DSN AI Bootcamp Participant](#)



Victor Adewusi

(Group Chief Data Officer, Access Holdings plc)

During the DSN AI Bootcamp Victor Adewusi spoke on Generative AI and the Future of Work: Opportunities for Emerging Markets (Oct 21, 2025)

“AI can’t replace you, but the people who use AI can replace you”

Read more: [DSN LinkedIn Page](#)

Follow us on Our Social Media Pages

LinkedIn - <https://www.linkedin.com/company/nigeria-ai-collective/>

Twitter - <https://x.com/aicollectiveng>

Or send us a mail at: NigerianAICollective@datasciencenigeria.ai